Avoiding Common Mistakes - Tutorial Quiz

Total points 8/13

Welcome to Mercor!

Please take this onboarding quiz - it is designed to teach you to avoid some common pitfalls in the tasks you will be writing.

Good luck!

Email *

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0 of 0 points

What project are you working on? *

- ○ Project Lucius (teachers)
- ○ Project MLI Dev Set
- ○ Argentum
- ◉ Rubrics Bootcamp
- ○ Other: .....

2 of 2 points

✓ You are writing a medical diagnosis task. Which weight should the criterion "Concludes the diagnosis is Type 2 Diabetes" have most probably? *1/1

- ○ Not-primary
- ◉ Primary ✓

Feedback

Primary

✓ A writer writes this criterion: "States that the company's 2024 revenue was $15M and its net profit was $2.5M." and assigns it a "minor" criteria weight. What do you think? *1/1

- ○ Strong criterion, nice and specific
- ◉ It's stacked and should be split into two criteria ✓
- ○ It is underweighted at 'minor strength'
- ○ It is not specific enough

Feedback

It's stacked and should be split into two criteria

2 of 2 points

✓ Imagine Criterion 20 is: "Identifies the author of the novel 'Dune' as Frank Herbert, citing the book's official publication data." Which of the following would be an acceptable Criterion 21? *1/1

- ○ Notes that the same novel was published in 1965.
- ◉ Identifies that the novel 'Dune' was published in 1965, per its official publication data. ✓
- ○ Following the above, identifies the publication year as 1965.
- ○ For the same author, states the publication year was 1965.

Feedback

Identifies that the novel 'Dune' was published in 1965, per its official publication data.

✓ A contractor is reviewing this rubric criterion: "Sufficiently details the historical context leading up to the start of World War I". What is the primary flaw in this criterion according to the guidelines? *1/1

- ○ The rationale is missing.
- ○ It does not match the prompt's expectations.
- ◉ It is not binary and objective. ✓
- ○ It should have a 'Primary' weight.

Feedback

It is not binary and objective.

1 of 3 points

✓ A prompt asks the model to identify the European country with the highest GDP in 2024, and then retrieve that country's capital city. *1/1

What is the correct dependency for the **second** criterion (retrieving the capital)?

- ○ No dependency, because the capital city is retrieved directly from a source.
- ◉ Dependent on the first criterion (identifying the country). ✓
- ○ No dependency, because it uses a different source.
- ○ Dependent on both the first criterion and its source.

Feedback

Dependent on the first criterion (identifying the country).

✗ Criterion 31 uses "Company-Q3-Report.pdf" to identify total assets. Criterion 32 is dependent on C31 and uses the asset value to calculate a debt-to-asset ratio. How should the 'Source(s)' field for Criterion 32 be filled? *0/1

- (●) Company-Q3-Report.pdf ✗
- ( ) The prompt
- ( ) No sources should be listed.

Correct answer

- (●) No sources should be listed.

Feedback

This is a common point of confusion. The guidelines specify that for a dependent criterion, you should not list the sources of its parent criteria. The dependency link itself is what connects it back to the original source.

✗ Which of the following criteria for the prompt "Analyse the themes of xxx novel by xxx author" demonstrates the HIGHEST overall quality, considering ALL rubric rules? *0/1

- (●) Criterion A: Accurately identifies the main theme as 'love' and the secondary theme as 'betrayal'. ✗
- ( ) Criterion B: Discusses the historical context of the novel, citing a source.
- ( ) Criterion C: Concludes that the character of Sid's main motivation is revenge.
- ( ) Criterion D: States the word count of chapter 4 is 3,458.

Correct answer

- (●) Criterion C: Concludes that the character of Sid's main motivation is revenge.

Feedback

This question requires holistic evaluation. Let's break down the flaws: A is 'stacked' and uses a forbidden word ('Accurately'). B is vague ("discusses"). D is irrelevant. C is the only clean, single, self-contained statement.

3 of 3 points

✓ A financial model's final stock valuation is $150.375. The prompt does not specify rounding. An intermediate step simplifies the final calculation but is not strictly required.
How should a criterion for this step be written? *1/1

- ○ Weight: Primary. Criterion: Calculates the intermediate value as 45.5.
- ○ Weight: Not primary. Criterion: Calculates the intermediate value.
- ◉ Weight: Not primary. Criterion: Notes the intermediate value simplifies to approximately 45.5. ✓
- ○ Weight: Primary. Criterion: States the intermediate value is 45.512, which is helpful.

Feedback

Weight: Minor. Criterion: Notes the intermediate value simplifies to approximately 45.5.

✓ A prompt asks for a lesson plan about the solar system. A very common student misconception is that Earth's seasons are caused by the planet's distance from the Sun. Which criterion BEST follows the guideline to penalize common misconceptions? *1/1

- ○ States that the Earth is the third planet from the Sun.
- ○ Includes a hands-on activity for students.
- ◉ Specifies that the Earth's axial tilt, not its orbital distance from the Sun, is the primary cause of the seasons. ✓
- ○ Lists the names of all eight planets in the correct order.

Feedback

Specifies that the Earth's axial tilt, not its orbital distance from the Sun, is the primary cause of the seasons.

✓ A criterion is: "Calculates the required dosage of Medicine X as 250mg". The prompt provided the patient's weight (50kg) and the dosage rule (5mg per kg). Which of the following is the most appropriate and complete Rationale for this criterion? *1/1

- ○ "The calculation is correct based on the prompt."
- ○ "Medicine X Dosage Calculation"
- ◉ The calculation uses the provided rule: 50kg * 5mg/kg = 250mg. ✓
- ○ "Source: The prompt"

Feedback

*The calculation uses the provided rule: 50kg * 5mg/kg = 250mg.*

0 of 3 points

✗ The prompt is: "List the ingredients and baking instructions for a standard sourdough bread loaf.". A writer writes the following rubric criterion: "States that Tartine is a bakery famous for its sourdough". What is the fundamental problem with this rubric criterion? *0/1

- ○ The criterion is stacked.
- ○ The criterion does not match the prompt's expectations.
- ○ The criterion is not self-contained.
- ◉ The criterion uses subjective language. ✗
- ○ The criterion is not verifiable.

Correct answer

- ◉ The criterion does not match the prompt's expectations.

Feedback

A core rule is that "Every request within the prompt must have a corresponding rubric criterion." The inverse is also true: every rubric criterion must correspond to a request in the prompt. Since the prompt did not ask for ideal environmental conditions, this criterion is invalid as it evaluates something outside the task's scope.

✗ A prompt asks for an estimate of the total final cost of a project plan. Review these criteria: (C20, Weight: Primary) States the cost for Phase 1 is $5,000. (C21, Weight: Primary) States the cost for Phase 2 is $10,000. (C22, Weight: Primary) Calculates the final total budget for the project as $15,000. Which statement best describes the correct weighting for these criteria? *0/1

- ○ The weight for C20 should be not-primary.
- ○ The weight for C20 and C21 should be not-primary.
- ○ All criteria weightings should be not-primary.
- ◉ All criteria weightings are correct. ✗

Correct answer

- ◉ The weight for C20 and C21 should be not-primary.

Feedback

The definition of a 'Primary objective" is a direct response to the questions asked in the prompt. Without this piece of information, the response is incorrect or incomplete

"Not primary objective" refers to information that is not explicitly asked for in the prompt, but that materially improves the quality of the response

The final total budget is the single most important output of this prompt and thus, is a "Primary objective."

✗ A physics problem requires these steps: 1. Calculate an object's momentum (p = m*v). 2. Use the momentum to calculate its de Broglie wavelength (λ = h/p). The criteria are: C41: Calculates the momentum (p). C42: Identifies the value of Planck's constant (h). C43: Calculates the de Broglie wavelength (λ). *0/1

What is the correct dependency mapping for this set of criteria?

- ○ C43 is dependent on C41.
- ◉ C43 is dependent on C42. ✗
- ○ C43 is dependent on C41 and C42.
- ○ C41 is dependent on C42 and C43.

Correct answer

- ◉ C43 is dependent on C41 and C42.

Feedback

Dependency mapping requires you to identify all direct inputs for a calculation. The formula for wavelength (λ = h/p) explicitly requires both h (from C42) and p (from C41). If either C41 or C42 were wrong, C43 would also be wrong.

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